

Seed heads

When flowering has finished, a puffy white seed head develops, full of seeds. A light breeze is all that's needed to blow the seeds away.

Each seed is attached by a stalk to a "parachute" that helps it drift on the wind.

Spreading seeds

Most seeds land close to the plant they came from—the parent plant. Other seeds travel on the wind far away. The seeds of unpollinated flowers grow into new plants. These are copies, or clones, of the parent plant.

The delicate parachute is actually a tuft of around 100 threadlike hairs.

See also

Find out about flowering plants that must always be pollinated to make seeds—orchids (58–59) and oaks (62–63).

Remora This fish has a sucker on its head that lets it attach itself harmlessly to bigger sea creatures, such as a shark. The remora gets a free ride, protection, and food scraps from the shark.



Pseudoscorpion These tiny creatures are related to scorpions. They hitch a ride by clinging to flying insects. This doesn't harm the insects, and the pseudoscorpions get to travel much farther than they could on their own.